

Below is a collection of some of the messages identified by students and the instructional team of what lies “below the surface” for various campus culture topics. Your job is to discuss how implicit biases play into these messages, the role you play in these topics, and how you can create a ripple effect to make positive change in the topic.

Relationships:

- “College is such an easy place to find your people”
- “Everyone is happy with the friends they make in college”
- “You should ask them out, they’re so easy”
- “Did you lock someone down for cuffing season?”

Sleep:

- “I’ve never had a good night sleep”
- “You don’t need sleep, just drink a red bull”
- “In college, you can choose grades, friends, or sleep, but not all three”
- “I can’t fall asleep without melatonin”

Mental Health:

- “Everyone is stressed, just deal with it”
- “You’re probably just tired”
- “CAPS doesn’t actually help”
- “My family wouldn’t approve of me going to therapy”

Academics:

- “If you’re not stressed, you’re not working hard enough”
- “Getting a bad grade means you’re a failure”
- “Asking for help makes you weak”
- “I can’t take a sick day, I need to go to class”

Body Image:

- “I can’t afford to eat healthy all the time”
- “Why don’t you just eat less?”
- “I’m on a spring break diet”
- “How can you be so pretty without even trying?”

Sex and Sexual Health:

- “It doesn’t feel the same with a condom”
- “Everyone loses their v-card in college”
- “It’s just a hook-up, it doesn’t mean anything”
- “Did you hear someone on our floor got an STI?”